Arthakriya (causal effectiveness): according to the Buddhist ***Dharmakirti***, to exist is to be causally effective. Objective reality (*vastu*), independent of experiences, is defined as the capacity for being causally active. Only unique momentary particulars (***svalakshana***) are real and they are given only in immediate perceptual sensations. This criterion of reality rules out the existence of anything supposedly eternal and unchanging such as God, souls, the sounds of the Vedic scriptures, and primal material nature that is inert prior to its plural manifestation as the cosmos.

It appears that prior to ***Dharmakirti*** some of the ***Abhidharma*** thinkers applied the causal efficacy criterion of reality to conditioned, compound entities.

Dharmakirti's inference called *sattva-anumana* runs 'All realities are momentary, because existence consists in being causally effective. What is permanent has no causal functions (like a hare's horn) and is not real.' The use of the fictional example (obviously, there could not be a real one) invited the objection from realists, especially in the ***Nyaya*** school and their sympathisers, that the inference was invalid.

Further reading: Dunne 2004; Mookerjee 1975

Arthapatti (presumption): a form of inferential reasoning recognised as a reliable instrument of instrument of knowledge in its own right by ***Kumarila***. Examples are: 'If fat Devadatta does not eat by day, he must eat by night'; 'If there were no persisting self that could anticipate the results of its actions, people would not act with view to future consequences.'

Further reading: Hiriyanna 1993; Suryanarayana Sastri 1942

Asatkaryavada ('production of something new'): the ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika*** theory of causation saying that, prior to